



FAMILY FACT FILE

Many different types of mammal feed on insects. Although these insect-eaters share some key features, they aren't closely related and don't make up a true animal family.

Key features

- Coats of fur or hair
- Pointed snouts
- Short legs
- Claws for climbing and digging

Glyptodon

GLIP-toe-don

- **When** 2 million–10,000 years ago (Neogene)
- **Fossil location** S. America
- **Habitat** Swamps
- **Length** 6½ ft (2 m)
- **Diet** Plants

Glyptodon was a giant relative of today's armadillos, but unlike an armadillo it ate plants rather than insects. It was an enormous animal, weighing as much as a small car. Its armor was made up of more than a thousand small, bony



plates arranged like tiles over its back and tail. It had a small, helmetlike head and flat-topped teeth for grinding tough leaves.

LIVING RELATIVE

Like their ancient relative *Glyptodon*, armadillos have armor made up of bony plates to protect themselves from predators. Baby armadillos are born with soft shells, which harden as they grow. The three-banded armadillo can roll into a ball to protect its soft underbelly; other armadillo species drop to the ground and pull in their legs.



Eurotamandua

YOU-row-ta-MAN-doo-ah

- **When** 50–40 million years ago (Early Paleogene)
- **Fossil location** Germany
- **Habitat** Woodlands
- **Length** 3 ft (1 m)
- **Diet** Ants and termites

Eurotamandua was a close relative of modern pangolins. Pangolins have no teeth and feed by ripping open ant and termite nests with their claws and collecting insects with a long, sticky tongue. *Eurotamandua* had no teeth but had a long snout and probably a long tongue, too. It also had a flexible, muscular tail with which it might have gripped branches while climbing.



Deinogalerix

DIE-no-GAL-eh-rix

- **When** 10–5 million years ago (Late Neogene)
- **Fossil location** Italy
- **Habitat** Woodlands
- **Length** 2 ft (0.5 m)
- **Diet** Probably insects and dead meat

Although its name means “terrible hedgehog,” *Deinogalerix* did not have spines like its modern relatives. Instead, its body was covered with hair. With its long, conical snout, small pointed ears, and a tapering tail, it looked more like a giant rat than a hedgehog. *Deinogalerix* perhaps fed on large insects such as beetles and crickets, but it may also have eaten birds and small mammals, as well as scavenging meat from carcasses. Rather than chasing after prey, it probably rooted through the undergrowth, snapping at any small animal it came across before the victim had time to escape.

